

6 Android/OpenMoko

We have covered the present of mobile phones in a lot of detail let us look at the some of the less famous alternatives which have the capability to hit mainstream, or have already become popular in certain regions of the world. We will be concentrating on namely two of them, one being “Android OS” and the other being “OpenMoko”.

The most recent product from Google’s kitty bag, Android was released by Google™ to take on the such as iPhone, Blackberry, Palm OS and latest Windows 6 mods. Seamless integration and a profound web browsing experience are the highlights of it.



Default Homescreen of iPhone 3GS running OS 3.0

6.1 Android

In July 2005, Google bought over Android, Inc., a small startup company based in Palo Alto, California, USA. At that time, very little was known about that company except that it made software for mobile technology. This ran speculations in the market that Google was planning to enter Mobile market. More speculations came in December 2006 when reports from the BBC and The Wall Street Journal noted that Google wanted its search and other applications on mobile phones and it was striving hard to deliver that. Finally on November 05, 2007 the Open Handset Alliance, a consortium of several companies including Broadcom Corporation, HTC, Intel, LG, Marvell Technology Group, Motorola, NVIDIA, Qualcomm, Samsung Electronics, Sprint Nextel, T-Mobile, Texas Instruments and Google was unveiled with an aim to standardise and develop open standards for mobile devices. Along with its formation, the OHA also unveiled their first product, Android, a mobile device platform built on the Linux kernel version 2.6 (monolithic). As promised by Google to keep open standards, Android was licensed under Apache, an open source and free software license.

Android is a software stack for mobile devices that includes an operating system, middleware and key applications. User applications can be developed using Android SDK which supplies a host of API's needed for development using the Java programming language. Salient features of Android are: